Mike Roberts

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Engineering Leadership

Developer Velocity | Agentic SDLC | Platform Architecture | People Leadership | Strategy

I'm an engineering leader who still ships code every day, and I think every engineering leader should. For two decades my focus has been *how* we ship, not just *what*: CI/CD, build systems, platforms, and now fully agentic development. I've pivoted a business into an entirely new product in nine months, rebuilt how a public company writes software, and grown a recommendation engine into a quarter of company revenue. I like hard problems, honest conversations, and winning.

SKILLS

Leadership: Strategy, Org Design, Hiring, Mentoring, Performance Management, Process Design, Partner Management

AI & Developer Tooling: Agentic Workflows, Claude Code, LLM-driven SDLC, CI/CD, Gradle, Terraform, Recommendation Models

Platform: Kotlin, Java, Scala, Ruby, Python, GraphQL, Kafka, Postgres, MySQL, Redis, AWS

EXPERIENCE

CarGurus — Cambridge, MA — April 2021 – present

Senior Manager, Algorithmic Traffic Acquisition

- Invented and am the primary author of **Mauve**, CarGurus' fully agentic SDLC: Jira ticket to pull request with no human needed. Building it changed how all of CarGurus develops software.
- Hands-on with AI tools daily; personally shipped multiple new recommendation models to production in 2026.
- Grew recommendations to 25% of CarGurus' total revenue while leading the recommendation and content teams.
- Built ATA's CI/CD system and standard Kotlin platform, cutting feature lead time from days to 15 minutes.
- Redesigned recommendation infrastructure to hold a 50ms SLA and improve engine performance 60%; built custom AWS auto-scaling that saved $100k monthly.
- Proposed and built a cross-company user stitching service, unifying siloed data for personalization.
- Cut advertising partner onboarding from 6+ months to 30 days; held paid channels at 40% of revenue while lowering cost.

Indigo Agriculture — Charlestown, MA — June 2019 – April 2021

Principal Engineer (Manager & Architect), Enterprise Services

- Led the back office settlements team and shipped Indigo's first high-availability, 24/7 services, with on-call plans and runbooks.
- Architected the event-sourcing core of the grain marketplace and the service bus connecting dozens of microservices.

Salsify — Boston, MA — December 2016 – June 2019

Principal Engineer (Manager), Platform Services

- Led the platform team; built a fair, multi-tenant job system running tens of millions of jobs daily, and Salsify's Kafka event bus and GraphQL framework.

Leaf Holdings — Cambridge, MA — November 2013 – May 2015

Software Engineering Manager (Director), Platform

- Led the Android and platform teams (3 managers, 18 engineers); hired dozens of engineers, plus a remote contract team in Istanbul.
- Took a pre-funding proof of concept to a production system serving thousands of restaurants; designed a Paxos-based data store spanning Android tablets and AWS.

Smarter Travel Media (TripAdvisor) — Charlestown, MA — April 2009 – April 2013

Software Engineering Manager (Director), Platform

- Led the pivot from an advertising network (BBDN) to **Tingo.com**, a ground-up hotel OTA, in nine months: real consumers, SEO, SEM, payments, customer support, and back office.
- Built the Tingo team (12 engineers) and microservice platform, later reused across TripAdvisor sites; CI and TDD kept uptime above 99.9%. Ran STM's architecture review board.

EDUCATION

Worcester Polytechnic Institute — B.S. Computer Science and B.S. Theatre

FAQ

Shell? zsh **Vim or Emacs?** Vim **Kanban or Scrum?** Kanban, but every team is different
Star Trek or Star Wars? Star Trek **Kirk or Picard?** Janeway